

Counsel to a King

Ārya-rāja-avavādaka-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra · Toh 221 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་རྒྱལ་པོ་ལོ་གདམས་པ་ཞེས་བརྒྱ་ཐག་པ་ཆེན་པོའི་མདོ།

Toh 221 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in English as "Counsel to a King," in Sanskrit as the Ārya-rāja-avavādaka-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra, and in Tibetan as the Phags pa rgyal po la gdams pa zhes bya ba theg pa chen po'i mdo. It belongs to the general class of Mahāyāna sūtras and presents teachings that the Buddha delivers in the context of a royal visit, with Prasenajit, King of Kosala, traveling to the Jeta Grove in Śrāvastī to pay homage, make offerings, and receive the Dharma. The setting — a great assembly of monks gathered around the Blessed One — frames what is evidently a discourse addressed to a monarch, exploring themes of guidance and instruction suited to one who holds worldly power. As its title suggests, the text is concerned with counsel given to a king, situating it within a broader tradition of Buddhist literature that reflects on the relationship between spiritual teaching and royal life.

In the language of India: Ārya-rāja-avavādaka-nāma-mahāyāna-sūtra. In the language of Tibet: the Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called "Counsel to a King."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling in Śrāvastī, in the Jeta Grove — the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada — together with a great Saṅgha of one thousand two hundred and fifty monks. At that time, Prasenajit, King of the land of Kosala, having come from Śrāvastī with great royal splendor and with great royal power, accompanied by many musicians playing cymbals, and surrounded by many hundreds and thousands of brahmins and householders, set out to see the Blessed One, to pay homage to him, to make offerings, to render him honor, and to hear the Dharma. He traveled to the Jeta Grove, the garden of Anāthapiṇḍada, riding upon his mount as far as the ground permitted a mount, then dismounted and proceeded on foot into the garden.

There King Prasenajit of Kosala saw, from a great distance, the Blessed One seated at the foot of a tree — beautiful, pleasing to behold, with faculties at peace, with mind at peace, tamed, one who had attained the highest calm abiding, endowed with the supreme excellence of discipline and tranquility, restrained, with senses tamed, a man like an elephant, a man like a lion, a man supremely noble like a bull among the herd, a man of perfect knowledge, clear and bright like a lake, without turbidity, his body beautifully adorned with

the thirty-two marks of a great being, his form gloriously arrayed with the eighty minor marks, blazing with splendor and exalted like a golden shrine. Upon seeing him, the king was filled with the greatest delight, and faith arose in his mind. He set aside the five royal insignia of a king anointed over the crown at the royal consecration — a king who has gained the power to rule over his realm — namely the diadem, the parasol, the sword, the jewel-handled fan, and the embroidered shoes. Then he went to where the Blessed One was, approached him, and bowed his head to the Blessed One's feet. He circumambulated the Blessed One three times, and the Blessed One gave his assent, whereupon the king sat down to one side.

Then King Prasenajit of Kosala addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, may the Blessed One please counsel me so that I may long have benefit, healing, and happiness. May the Sugata please instruct me in this way."

When he had spoken thus, the Blessed One declared to King Prasenajit of Kosala: "Great King, it is excellent, excellent, that you wish to ask the Tathāgata about this matter. Therefore, Great King, rule your kingdom by Dharma — not by what is not Dharma. Conduct yourself in accordance with the Dharma — not in accordance with what is not Dharma. And why is this? Great King, any king or minister of a king who abandons Dharma and rules by what is not Dharma — in this very life, the noble and virtuous will censure him, and afterward he will come to regret it. When his body perishes and he dies, he will fall into the lower realms, the evil destinies, the downward courses, and be reborn in the hells.

"Great King, any king or minister of a king who abandons what is not Dharma and rules by Dharma, not by what is not Dharma — in this very life, the noble and virtuous will praise him, and afterward he will have no regret.

When his body perishes and he dies, he will be reborn in the happy realms, the higher worlds, among the gods.

Great King, consider this example: just as parents, out of loving affection for their children, always wish them to be happy and free from harm, so too should a king always gather his male servants and female servants, his workers and those who live on wages, his friends and advisors, his relatives and the people of his towns and cities, binding them together through the four means of gathering. And what are the four? Great King, they are these: generosity, pleasant speech, beneficial conduct, and acting in accordance with

others' aims. A king who gathers his male servants and female servants, his workers and those who live on wages, his friends and advisors, his relatives and the people of his towns and cities in this way will himself gather and attract two benefits. And what are the two? The benefit of this life and the benefit of lives to come. Great King, in this regard the king is like a father and mother, and the male servants and female servants, the workers and those who live on wages, the friends and advisors, the relatives and the people of the towns and cities are like the king's sons and daughters.

Great King, consider this example: a man or woman who falls asleep and, in the dream state, sees a beautiful park, a beautiful mountain, a beautiful forest, a beautiful river, a beautiful pond, a beautiful countryside, and beautiful mansions — and then, upon waking, sees nothing at all. Great King, in just the same way, the kingdom, the life itself, the happiness of a kingdom, the happiness of royal sovereignty, the happiness of desires, and the happiness that comes from enjoying desired things — all of these are like a dream. That is: elephants, horses, chariots, infantry troops, women, houses, a noble queen, youths, ministers, accountants, great ministers, herdsman, retinue, father, mother, brothers, sisters, wives, sons, daughters, youth, male servants, female servants, workers, those who live on wages, friends, advisors, relatives, the people of the towns and cities, guests, gold, jewels, precious gems, pearls, lapis lazuli, conch shells, crystal, coral, fine cloth, silver, garments, ornaments, wealth, grain, storerooms, and treasuries — all of these must be left behind and departed from. Every single one of them is impermanent, unstable, untrustworthy, subject to change, short-lived, not abiding, wavering, trembling, breaking down, momentary, a gateway to dissolution and dispersal, subject by nature to final destruction, scattering in the end, fraught with danger, fraught with harm, attended by grief, full of agitation, subject to wearing away, to crumbling, to exhaustion, to separation, to ruin, to utter disintegration. Therefore, Great King, you must regard them as impermanent, see them as a gateway to dissolution and dispersal, and feel fear and dread in the face of death.

Great King, rule your kingdom by Dharma alone, not by what is not Dharma. Accord yourself with Dharma, not with what is not Dharma. And why is this? Great King, consider this example: from trees, blossoms arise and from them fruits come forth; once they have become fruits, those fruits too disappear. Green leaves turn yellow, and once they have turned yellow, they vanish altogether from every place. Great King, consider this example: a great mass

of fire blazing, burning intensely —

however vast it blazes and burns, however long its flames leap up as one, in the end it will be extinguished. The sun and the moon, renowned for such great supernatural power, such great might, such great sovereignty, adorned with their own splendor — even these two will illuminate this world and then set. The sons of the gods who gather clouds or bring forth rain sound their thunder, release their voice, cover the sky, and pour down streams of rain — and yet even that rain will in the end cease to appear. Great King, in just the same way, the happiness of royal dominion, the happiness of a king's sovereignty, the happiness of sense pleasures, and the happiness of enjoying objects of desire — all of these too are like a dream.

Consider: elephants, cavalry, chariots, foot soldiers, women, houses, noble wives, young men, ministers, accountants, great ministers, herdsman, retinues, fathers, mothers, brothers, sisters, wives, sons, daughters, those of one's own age, male servants, female servants, workers, those who live on dairy wages, friends, ministers, kin, townspeople, guests, gold, jewels, precious things, pearls, beryl, conch, crystal, coral, fine grain, silver, clothing, ornaments, wealth, grain, storehouses, granaries, and all the rest — all of these must be abandoned and left behind. Every one of them is impermanent, unstable, unreliable, subject to change, short-lived, transient, trembling, shaking, ending in destruction, momentary, ending in ruin, a gateway to exhaustion and dispersion, subject by nature to dissolution, accompanied by decay, accompanied by harm, full of sorrow and turmoil, declining, crumbling, ceasing, separating, dispersing, subject to destruction. Great King, you should look upon them as impermanent, see them as a gateway to exhaustion and dispersion, and feel fear and dread in the face of death. Rule your kingdom by Dharma alone, not by what is not Dharma. Accord yourself with Dharma, not with what is not Dharma.

And why is this? Great King, consider this example: from the four directions, four great mountains come, solid, stable, possessed of a core, unshattered, uncleft, without fissure, utterly hard, densely compacted — they touch the sky and roll back the earth, grinding to powder all grasses, trees, vines, branches, and leaves, and every living sentient being and creature. It would not be easy to flee from them by speed, to repel them by force, to ward them off by wealth, or to turn them aside by mantras, substances, or medicines. Great King, in just the same way, these four great terrors come, and from them too it would not be easy to flee by speed, to repel them by force, to ward them off

by wealth, or to pacify them by substances, mantras, or medicines. What are the four? Old age, illness, death, and decline. Great King, old age comes crushing the prime of life. Illness comes crushing the absence of sickness. Decline comes crushing all prosperity and abundance. Death comes crushing the life-force itself. From these it would not be easy to flee by speed, to repel them by force, to ward them off by wealth, or to pacify them by substances, mantras, or medicines.

Great King, consider this example: the lion, king of beasts, enters into the midst of a herd of animals, seizes the animals, and does with them exactly as he pleases.

Those animals, seized in the grip of the mighty lion's jaws, become utterly powerless. Great King, in just the same way, when one is pierced by the spear of the Lord of Death, one is stripped of pride, left without a protector, without a refuge, without allies. The constitution breaks down, the joints come apart, flesh and blood dry up, the body is tormented by sickness, thirst parches, the face changes, the limbs tremble, one can no longer act, power is gone. Saliva, mucus, urine, and vomit soil the body. The faculties of eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind cease to function. Hiccups come, harsh rattling sounds emerge, the physicians give up. Medicines, food, drink, and all manner of gruel are tasted and discarded. One lies down on the final bed from which one will go to other realms. One sinks into the continuum of saṃsāra, without beginning, of birth, old age, sickness, and death. With only a flickering of life remaining, one is terrified by the men of Yama, the Lord of Death, one falls under the power of unconsciousness, the breath ceases, the mouth and nose gape, the teeth are bared, and one cries out, "Give — give away the wealth!" One passes from the existence created by karma into yet another existence. Alone, without companion, without a second, one abandons this world and goes to the world beyond. One is lifted by a great lament, one enters into great darkness, one falls into a great abyss, one enters a dense wilderness, one goes into a vast solitude, one is carried away by a great ocean, one is swept off by the winds of karma, one goes in a direction where there is no ground to stand on, one enters a great battlefield, one is seized by a great demon, one wanders through the sky. Surrounded by father and mother, brothers and sisters, sons and daughters, the breath stops. "Divide and distribute the wealth," they say. "Alas, my mother! Alas, my father! Alas, my child!" they cry. The hair falls out. When generosity, ascetic practice, and Dharma alone have become one's companions, apart from Dharma there is no

other refuge, no other protector, no other abode, no other ally.

Great King, at that time and in that moment, Dharma becomes one's island, one's abode, one's protector, one's support.

Great King, consider this example: for one threatened by cold, fire is a protection; for one utterly consumed by fire, the quenching of the fire; for one threatened by heat, coolness; for a weary traveler, shade and a cool breeze; for one who is thirsty, cool water; for one who has set out on a journey, a mount; for one lying down, a soft bed; for one parched, cold water; for one desperately hungry, fine food; for one oppressed by grief, relief and consolation; for one tormented, soothing comfort; for one who has lost the way in a deserted region, a guide to the path; for one struck by sickness, a physician, medicine, and a nurse; for one swept away by a river, a raft; for one sunk in mud, a hand reached out; for one who finds a crossing difficult, a bridge; for one in a precarious place, a ladder to descend; in a dark room, a lamp; on a great ocean, a boat; for one threatened by a storm, a place without wind; for one gone to a distant land, provisions for the journey; for one who is poor, wealth; for one who wishes to accomplish something, a companion; for one who wishes to cut, a blade; for one who wishes to demolish, a vajra; for one who has entered battle, armor; for one who is afraid, a powerful friend; for one engaged in fighting, an ally; for one facing oppression, a liberator; in famine, those possessed of wealth become a protector, a refuge, an abode, and a support — even so, Great King, when one is pierced by the spear of the Lord of Death, stripped of pride, left without a protector, without a refuge, without allies, when the constitution breaks down, the joints come apart, flesh and blood dry up, the body is tormented by sickness, one is parched with thirst, and the face changes —

the limbs tremble, one can no longer act, all strength is gone; saliva, urine, and vomit soil the body; the faculties of eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind cease to function; hiccups arise; harsh, rasping sounds emerge; the physician abandons the patient; all medicines, food, soft foods, solid foods, and gruel become repellent and are cast aside; and one lies down on the last bed, about to depart for another existence. One sinks into the stream of saṃsāra — of birth, aging, sickness, and death without beginning — and with whatever little life remains, one is terrified by the henchmen of the Lord of Death, falls under the power of delusion, the breathing ceases, the mouth and nose fall open, the teeth are bared, and one makes the supplication: "May I give, may I give." Then karma drives one from one existence into the next.

Alone, without a companion, without a second, one abandons this world and goes to the world beyond. One is lifted by a great weight of suffering, enters great darkness, falls into a great abyss, plunges into dense thickets, goes into a great wilderness, is swept along by a great ocean, blown by the wind of karma, and moves toward a direction where there is no ground to stand on. At that moment, apart from the Dharma, there is no other protector, no other refuge, no other ally.

Great King, at that very time and moment, the Dharma alone becomes a great island, a dwelling, a protector, a refuge, an ally, and a support. Great King, at that time one thinks: "Alas, where am I going? In which direction am I going? Where will I find something to hold on to? Who will be my mother?" And if one then sees oneself being born among the hell-beings — the Avīci hell, the hot hells, the extremely hot hells, and so forth — one experiences for many years, for many hundreds of years, for many thousands of years, great suffering, unbearable suffering, fierce, violent, and unpleasant sensations. For as long as all the evil and unwholesome karma by which one is to experience birth in the hells has not been completely exhausted and purified, one does not die. If one then sees oneself being born in the animal realm — for instance, creatures in the depths of the great ocean, fish both cold and warm, living beings slaughtering one another, harming one another, born without any freedom of their own. If one thinks: "Will I perhaps be born among the hungry ghosts?" — it is thus: for many years, for many hundreds of years, for many thousands of years, one does not even hear the sound of water — what need is there to speak of seeing it?

Great King, therefore you must look upon all things as impermanent, look upon them as subject to exhaustion and depletion, and be afraid of death. Rule your kingdom through the Dharma and not through what is contrary to the Dharma. Act in accordance with the Dharma and not in accordance with what is contrary to the Dharma. Why is this? Great King, this very body of yours — however well preserved and well tended it may be — will in time meet the moment of death. However long it may have been endowed with every good quality, however long it may have eaten, worn, savored, and been satiated with fine things, however often it may have been satisfied and nourished with many kinds of clean and fragrant food — when it lies on that last bed, the physician abandons it, and medicines, food, soft foods, and gruel also become repellent and are cast aside, and one dies oppressed by hunger and thirst, in distress of mind.

Great King, in just this way, however much you may bathe and anoint this body of yours, perfume it with incense, and anoint it with the sweet fragrance of flowers, inevitably, in its own time, the naturally arisen foul odor will appear of itself.

Great King, in just this way, however much this body may be wrapped in fine cloths — the cotton of Kāśikā, silk from Mon, Dukūla linen, silk brocade, woolen garments, woolen robes, and cotton — when it lies on that last bed, it will meet its hour of death drenched in many kinds of oil and water, wearing soiled garments.

Great King, in just this way, though you sit surrounded by women within your palace, dwelling in the midst of your queens' retinue, encircled by throngs of women, while dancing and singing and the sweet sounds of music are performed, and while the small cymbals are struck, the vīṇā and the flute are played, the drums are beaten, and you rejoice in pleasure of mind and move in delight — still, terrified of death, you will find yourself in great mental distress and come to the hour of death.

Great King, in just this way, though within your palace the body is anointed with the sweet fragrance of incense, sealed in plaster, the windows properly cut, smeared with many unguents, fine oil-butter lamps with sweet fragrance burn, many silken streamers are hung about, the vases are filled with the petals of sweet-scented flowers, perfume is wafted from a censer, the legs of the throne are fashioned from gold and silver and beryl, cushions of paṭṭikā and fine cloth are laid, with inner cushions spread with linen, under-cushions placed, cushions of the Kāliṅga style, a canopy stretched above, and that canopy draped over all, and you recline upon that throne with red silken curtains hung to either side — nonetheless, it is certain that you will be cast into a great and terrifying charnel ground, a supreme abode of crows, vultures, and foxes, of corpses and flesh and bones and hair and blood and pus and serum and discharge, and there you will lie upon the ground unable to stir.

Great King, in just this way too, though you ride upon the back of an elephant, on horseback, or in a chariot, with the various sweet sounds of conches and drums and earthen drums and kettledrums and musical instruments, with parasols and victory banners and pennants and triumphant banners raised aloft, with jewel-handled fans and yak-tail whiskers and palm-leaf fans waved about, with elephants and horsemen and numerous foot soldiers following behind, with princes and brahmins and learned ministers and court reciters

and many hundreds and thousands of people joining their palms and attending upon you with cries of "Hail to the Victor! Hail to the Victor!" — even so, before long, without stirring, dead upon your bed, you will be lifted by four men, and father and mother, brothers and sisters, wife and sons and daughters, male servants and female servants, laborers and those who live on wages and those who eat cooked food and ministers and the people of the city will fall under the power of grief, and raising their hands, beating their chests, weeping most pitifully, they will cry: "Alas, my dear one! Alas, my protector! Alas, my brother! Alas, my lord!" — and the people of the city, seeing with fear, will carry you out through the southern gate of the city and place you beneath the earth, or whether in a wilderness hermitage they place you beneath the earth, crows and vultures and foxes and the like will eat the body, and those bones will be burned by fire, or cast into water, or buried beneath the earth, and by wind and sun and rain they will be ground to dust and scattered in every direction, and in that very place they will decay.

Great King, in just this way the body of every sentient being will come to such an end.

Great King, all formations (saṃskāra) are impermanent in this way, unstable in this way, unreliable in this way, subject to change in this way — they are short-lived, unable to remain, wavering, trembling, momentary. Their end is the exhaustion of evil and their gateway is dispersion; in the end they scatter apart.

They are possessed of fear, possessed of harm, full of sorrow and turbulence — they are decaying, disintegrating, ceasing, dividing, scattering, subject to utter destruction.

Great King, therefore regard them as impermanent, seeing exhaustion and dispersion as their gateway. Do not be attached through desire, do not be averse through aversion, do not be confused through delusion. Be unattached to the happiness of royal sovereignty, unattached to the pleasures of sensual desire, unattached to the joy of sensual enjoyment. Regard all as impermanent; be heedful, unattached, unsatisfied, free from clinging, without inclination, without fondness — and be fearful of death, without the pride of life.

Govern your kingdom through Dharma alone; do not act through what is not Dharma. Act in accordance with Dharma; do not act in accordance with what is not Dharma. Why is that? Great King, I do not say that satiation comes from

the acquisition, attainment, accumulation, and thorough accumulation of sensual objects — for those who find satiation through noble wisdom (āryaprajñā), they are truly sated.

Great King, it is like this: conditioned by ignorance arise formations; conditioned by formations arises consciousness; conditioned by consciousness arise name-and-form; conditioned by name-and-form arise the six sense bases; conditioned by the six sense bases arises contact; conditioned by contact arises feeling; conditioned by feeling arises craving; conditioned by craving arises grasping; conditioned by grasping arises becoming; conditioned by becoming arises birth; conditioned by birth arise old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, displeasure, and distress. In this way arises this entire great mass of suffering.

And therein, when ignorance ceases, formations cease; when formations cease, consciousness ceases; when consciousness ceases, name-and-form ceases; when name-and-form ceases, the six sense bases cease; when the six sense bases cease, contact ceases; when contact ceases, feeling ceases; when feeling ceases, craving ceases; when craving ceases, grasping ceases; when grasping ceases, becoming ceases; when becoming ceases, birth ceases; when birth ceases, old age and death, sorrow, lamentation, suffering, displeasure, and distress all cease. In this way this entire great mass of suffering ceases.

Great King, therefore, with no attachment through desire, no aversion through aversion, no confusion through delusion, with royal sovereignty yet without the arrogance of power — govern your kingdom through Dharma alone; do not act through what is not Dharma. Act in accordance with Dharma; do not act in accordance with what is not Dharma. Why is that? Great King, I say that from the acquisition and attainment of sensual objects, up to and until there is no satiation — there will be no true satiation. Those who find satiation through noble wisdom, they are truly sated.

Then the Blessed One at that time declared these verses:

This human life will pass away;
the Lord of Death comes relentlessly.
This life of yours is not secure —
O King, do not be heedless.

Give up wealth and protect the body;
give up a limb and protect the life.

Wealth and limbs alike, and likewise life —
give up all of these, and here protect the Dharma.

One who practices Dharma is protected by the Dharma,
just as a great umbrella in the summer season guards from rain.

This is the benefit of practicing the Dharma:
one who practices the Dharma does not go to the lower realms.
One who practices what is not the Dharma and is heedless —
when they pass away from here, they go to unbearable lower realms.

There is no place in which one can remain
where death cannot reach:
not in the sky, not in the depths of the ocean,
and entering a mountain cave is of no avail.

Know this — those great terrors of death,
the dissolution of the aggregates and the cutting off of the life force.
Aspire to attain the deathless,
for once nirvāṇa is attained, one shall never die again.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, Prasenajit (Skt. Prasenajit), King of Kośala, and those eighty-four thousand living beings, together with the gods, humans, asuras (demigods), garuḍas, and gandharvas (Skt. gandharva) — all the worlds — rejoiced, and praised what the Blessed One had declared.

This concludes the Great Vehicle sūtra known as the Noble Teaching Given to a King.

Translated by the Indian masters Jinamitra and Śīlendrabodhi, and the great editor-translator the monk Yeshé Dé; revised and finalized in accordance with the new language edicts.

Translator's Notes

- The phrase rendered "healing" translates the Tibetan term that can mean both physician and medicine; in context it refers to the king's long-term welfare and well-being, carrying a connotation of the Buddha as a healer of afflictions. The five royal insignia listed correspond to the standard classical enumeration found in parallel sūtra passages. The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the provided passage; the translation follows the Tibetan as given.
- The list of precious substances includes "sa le sbram," which likely refers to a type of fine textile or perhaps red coral-cloth; it has been rendered "fine cloth" as a reasonable approximation. This is a minor lexical uncertainty.
- The list of valuables includes "ཁོ་གྲོ་བུ་སྤྱི་ལོ་འདྲེན་པ་མང་པོ་།," literally "those who live on dairy-portion

- The passage employs an extended anaphoric list of similes, a classical Indian rhetorical device. The phrase rendered "men of Yama" refers to the messengers or agents of Yama, the Lord of Death in Indian cosmology. The text concludes mid-sentence, corresponding to the source breaking off, and continues into the next passage.

The phrase マタノチカラナシ ("who will be my mother?") is a traditional expression of the dying person's utter helplessness and longing, found widely in Mahāyāna literature on impermanence and death.

The final sentence, "Their end is the exhaustion of evil and their gateway is dispersion," renders a compressed and somewhat elliptical Tibetan phrase. The phrase "mṭhar sdig pa zad pa" most naturally means "in the end, the exhaustion of demerit or wickedness" — possibly indicating that the ultimate result of impermanent formations is the wearing away of unwholesome karma, though the exact doctrinal sense in context may warrant further attention by specialists.

The final verse image — a great umbrella in summer — refers to protection from the monsoon rains, a common Indian simile for the Dharma sheltering the practitioner. The verse ends mid-image in the Tibetan as transmitted here; the simile is grammatically complete as given.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.